

雅思 7.0 阅读文章

10 篇词汇密集型阅读

建议使用方式 (每天约 30 分钟)

1. 第一遍：通读全文，生词根据上下文猜测，不要立刻查词典
2. 第二遍：划出仍不确定的词，查词典并记录在笔记本上
3. 记录时写下：单词 + 词性 + 原文例句 + 中文释义
4. 第三遍：重读文章，确认每个生词在语境中的确切含义
5. 隔天重读同一篇文章，直到标出的词都能认出来

每篇文章约 270-310 词，难度对标 IELTS Band 7.0 (CEFR C1)，涵盖环境、科技、教育、社会、健康、文化、工作、媒体、农业等雅思高频话题。文中刻意使用了大量学术词汇和复杂句式，适合通过阅读积累词汇。

Passage 1 The Accelerating Transition to Renewable Energy

环境 · Environment | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

The scientific consensus regarding anthropogenic climate change has become increasingly difficult to dispute. Decades of meticulous research have demonstrated that greenhouse gas emissions, principally from the combustion of fossil fuels, are driving unprecedented rises in global temperatures. The ramifications extend far beyond warmer summers: glaciers are retreating at an alarming rate, sea levels are encroaching upon coastal settlements, and the frequency of extreme meteorological events — including prolonged droughts, devastating floods, and destructive hurricanes — has intensified markedly.

In response, governments have pledged to pursue ambitious decarbonisation targets. Investment in renewable infrastructure, encompassing solar panels, offshore wind farms, and hydroelectric facilities, has surged across both developed and emerging economies. Proponents contend that a wholesale shift away from coal and petroleum is not merely an environmental imperative but an economic opportunity, capable of generating employment in green technology sectors and reducing dependence on volatile international energy markets. Critics, however, caution that the intermittent nature of wind and solar power necessitates substantial advances in battery storage before renewables can reliably supplant conventional sources.

The transition is further complicated by geopolitical considerations. Nations endowed with abundant fossil fuel reserves may resist policies that threaten their primary export industries, while developing countries argue that wealthy states, having historically contributed the lion's share of cumulative emissions, bear a disproportionate responsibility to finance climate adaptation. Achieving meaningful international cooperation therefore requires delicate negotiation and a willingness to compromise on seemingly intractable differences.

At the individual level, behavioural modifications — such as reducing discretionary air travel, adopting plant-based diets, and minimising household energy consumption — can collectively exert considerable influence. Nevertheless, experts emphasise that systemic change, driven by legislative frameworks and corporate accountability, will ultimately prove more decisive than isolated personal efforts. Carbon pricing mechanisms, subsidies for clean energy, and stringent emissions regulations represent the kind of policy instruments that can accelerate the transition at the scale required.

约 311 词

Passage 2 Artificial Intelligence and the Restructuring of Labour Markets

科技 · Technology | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Few technological developments have provoked as much speculation as the rapid proliferation of artificial intelligence. Machine-learning algorithms, capable of analysing vast datasets and identifying patterns imperceptible to human observers, are already transforming sectors ranging from medical diagnostics and financial forecasting to legal document review and autonomous vehicle navigation. The sheer velocity of innovation has prompted economists, policymakers, and workers alike to question what employment will resemble in the decades ahead.

Historical precedent offers a measure of reassurance. Previous industrial revolutions, though initially disruptive, ultimately generated new categories of work that predecessors could scarcely have envisaged. The advent of automobiles, for instance, eliminated jobs associated with horse-drawn transportation yet simultaneously created millions of positions in manufacturing, maintenance, and infrastructure development. Advocates of this optimistic narrative maintain that artificial intelligence will similarly augment human productivity rather than render it obsolete.

Sceptics draw attention to a crucial distinction: earlier technologies primarily automated physical tasks, whereas contemporary systems increasingly encroach upon cognitive domains previously considered exclusive to human intellect. Routine administrative functions, data entry, and even certain analytical roles are already being delegated to software. Workers whose skill sets overlap substantially with algorithmic capabilities may find themselves particularly vulnerable to displacement.

Educational institutions bear a corresponding obligation to adapt their curricula. Rote memorisation of factual information has diminished in value when search engines can retrieve answers instantaneously. Instead, educators increasingly prioritise critical thinking, creative problem-solving, interpersonal communication, and digital literacy. Governments, meanwhile, face mounting pressure to fund retraining programmes that enable mid-career professionals to acquire competencies aligned with evolving labour market demands. The outcome of this transition will depend not on technology alone, but on the foresight with which societies prepare their workforce.

约 279 词

Passage 3 Reimagining Higher Education for a Digital Era

教育 · Education | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Universities worldwide are confronting a period of profound transformation. The traditional model — characterised by large-scale lectures delivered in cavernous auditoriums, rigid semester schedules, and assessment through standardised examinations — is being progressively supplemented, and in some instances supplanted, by digital alternatives. Online platforms now enable students to access pre-recorded lectures, participate in virtual seminars, and submit assignments electronically, conferring a degree of flexibility that was previously unattainable for those balancing employment or family obligations alongside academic pursuits.

This democratisation of access represents a significant achievement. Individuals residing in geographically remote regions, or in countries where tertiary education remains prohibitively expensive, can now enrol in courses offered by prestigious institutions on the opposite side of the globe. Massive open online courses, commonly abbreviated as MOOCs, have attracted millions of registrants, though completion rates remain disappointingly low, suggesting that accessibility alone does not guarantee educational outcomes.

Employers, for their part, have expressed growing dissatisfaction with the practical preparedness of graduates. Surveys consistently indicate that recruiters prioritise demonstrable competencies — teamwork, adaptability, and proficiency with industry-specific tools — over academic credentials in isolation. In response, universities have cultivated partnerships with commercial enterprises, embedding internships and collaborative projects within degree programmes. Such initiatives aim to bridge the perennial gap between theoretical knowledge and workplace application.

Yet a faction of academics voices apprehension that the relentless emphasis on vocational utility may erode the intellectual foundations upon which higher education was originally conceived. They contend that universities should cultivate intellectual curiosity, ethical reasoning, and the capacity for independent inquiry, qualities that transcend any particular profession and equip graduates to navigate an unpredictable future. Striking an appropriate equilibrium between employability and intellectual breadth remains one of the defining challenges confronting contemporary academia.

约 286 词

Passage 4 Urbanisation and the Challenge of Sustainable City Planning

社会 · Society | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Humanity has crossed a demographic threshold of considerable significance: more than half the global population now resides in urban environments, and projections indicate that this proportion will continue to ascend throughout the twenty-first century. Cities function as magnets for economic activity, concentrating employment opportunities, educational institutions, and cultural amenities within a comparatively compact geographical footprint. Young adults, in particular, migrate from predominantly rural hinterlands in pursuit of enhanced career prospects and a more cosmopolitan lifestyle.

The consequences of unchecked urban expansion, however, are increasingly conspicuous. Escalating demand for housing has propelled property prices beyond the reach of low and middle-income residents, relegating many to overcrowded accommodation on the peripheral outskirts of metropolitan areas. Simultaneously, traffic congestion has reached chronic proportions in numerous cities, generating not only productivity losses but also dangerously elevated levels of atmospheric pollution. Municipal authorities frequently struggle to provision adequate sanitation, healthcare, and public transportation infrastructure for populations that expand far more rapidly than budgets allow.

Urban planners have accordingly championed the concept of the 'smart city' — an urban environment in which technology is harnessed to optimise resource allocation, reduce environmental impact, and enhance residents' quality of life. Proposed interventions include integrated public transit networks, expansive green corridors, energy-efficient building codes, and mixed-use neighbourhoods designed to minimise commuting distances. Proponents argue that thoughtful design can reconcile the competing imperatives of economic growth and ecological sustainability.

Implementation, inevitably, encounters formidable obstacles. Retrofitting existing infrastructure is vastly more expensive than incorporating sustainable principles into new developments, and political cycles rarely align with the long-term horizons that urban transformation demands. Gentrification — the displacement of established communities by affluent newcomers — further complicates redevelopment efforts. Nevertheless, the alternative of allowing cities to expand in an unplanned, haphazard fashion carries consequences that subsequent generations may find impossible to remedy.

约 299 词

Passage 5 Contemporary Challenges in Global Public Health

健康 · Health | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

The twentieth century witnessed extraordinary advances in medical science that collectively extended average life expectancy across much of the globe. Vaccination programmes eradicated smallpox and brought polio to the brink of elimination; antibiotics revolutionised the treatment of bacterial infections; and improvements in sanitation and nutrition dramatically reduced infant mortality. These achievements fostered a widespread assumption that infectious disease had been definitively conquered — an assumption that recent events have comprehensively undermined.

Paradoxically, as communicable illnesses have receded in relative importance in affluent nations, chronic non-communicable conditions have assumed predominance. Obesity, cardiovascular disease, type-two diabetes, and certain cancers now account for a substantial majority of the global disease burden. Sedentary lifestyles, diets disproportionately rich in processed foods and refined sugars, and pervasive occupational stress are implicated as contributing factors. Mental health disorders, including anxiety and depression, have likewise escalated to epidemic proportions, affecting individuals across socioeconomic strata and age cohorts.

Stark inequalities in health outcomes persist both between and within countries. While citizens of wealthy nations benefit from sophisticated healthcare systems and abundant pharmaceutical resources, populations in low-income regions frequently lack access to basic medical facilities, clean water, and essential vaccinations. The recent pandemic laid bare these disparities with brutal clarity, as vaccine distribution initially favoured the world's most prosperous economies while leaving vulnerable communities in the Global South disproportionately exposed.

Addressing these multifaceted challenges demands coordinated international effort. Surveillance systems must be strengthened to detect emerging pathogens before they achieve pandemic potential; research findings must be disseminated transparently across borders; and mechanisms must be established to ensure that life-saving treatments are distributed equitably rather than exclusively to those who can afford premium prices. Preventive medicine, encompassing public health campaigns and early intervention programmes, offers a more cost-effective strategy than treating advanced illness in overstretched hospital systems.

约 296 词

Passage 6 Preserving Cultural Heritage in an Era of Globalisation

文化 · Culture | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Cultural heritage constitutes far more than a collection of antiquated monuments and museum exhibits. It encompasses intangible traditions — oral histories, ceremonial practices, culinary techniques, and linguistic varieties — transmitted across generations and constitutive of communal identity. When a heritage site is destroyed or a minority language falls into disuse, an irreplaceable repository of human knowledge and perspective is irrevocably lost.

International organisations such as UNESCO have designated hundreds of locations as World Heritage Sites, conferring recognition upon places deemed to possess outstanding universal value. This designation frequently attracts tourism revenue that can fund restoration and conservation projects. Yet the relationship between tourism and preservation is inherently ambivalent. Excessive visitor numbers exert physical pressure upon fragile structures, while the commercialisation of sacred rituals for tourist consumption may dilute their authentic cultural significance.

Globalisation exerts a homogenising influence that threatens cultural diversity at an unprecedented scale. International media, multinational corporations, and dominant languages — particularly English — permeate societies that previously maintained distinctive customs and worldviews. Younger generations, exposed primarily to globalised popular culture, may regard local traditions as antiquated or irrelevant, accelerating the erosion of practices that endured for centuries.

Conservation strategies must therefore extend beyond the physical protection of buildings to encompass the revitalisation of living traditions. Educational initiatives that incorporate indigenous knowledge into school curricula, community-led documentation projects, and policies that protect linguistic rights all contribute to ensuring that heritage remains a dynamic, evolving dimension of contemporary society rather than a relic confined to institutional archives. Repatriation of artefacts removed during colonial periods has become an increasingly contentious issue, with source nations demanding the return of culturally significant objects held in Western museums.

约 275 词

Passage 7 The Gig Economy and the Future of Employment Relations

工作 · Work | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

The conventional employment paradigm — characterised by permanent contracts, fixed working hours, and comprehensive benefit packages — is undergoing substantial erosion. Digital platforms that connect freelance workers with short-term assignments have proliferated across industries, from ride-hailing and food delivery to graphic design, software development, and consulting. This emergent 'gig economy' offers a degree of temporal flexibility that appeals particularly to younger workers who prioritise autonomy and work-life equilibrium over the security traditionally associated with long-term employer-employee relationships.

From a corporate perspective, engaging independent contractors rather than permanent staff reduces overhead expenditure and enables organisations to scale their workforce in response to fluctuating demand. During periods of economic contraction, companies can terminate contractual arrangements without incurring the severance obligations or reputational costs associated with large-scale redundancies. This agility is especially prized in industries subject to rapid technological disruption.

The implications for workers are considerably less favourable. Gig participants typically forfeit access to employer-sponsored health insurance, paid annual leave, pension contributions, and protection against arbitrary dismissal — safeguards that labour movements fought to establish over generations. Income instability is endemic; earnings fluctuate unpredictably from week to week, complicating financial planning and mortgage applications. Critics contend that platforms have effectively externalised their operational costs onto a precarious workforce while retaining the profits generated by that labour.

Legislatures in several jurisdictions have begun to intervene. Courts and parliaments are grappling with the question of whether gig workers should be reclassified as employees entitled to statutory protections, or whether such classification would stifle the innovation that platforms represent. Trade unions, historically the primary advocates for worker rights, face the novel challenge of organising a dispersed, digitally mediated workforce that lacks a shared physical workplace. The resolution of this debate will exert a profound influence upon the structure of labour markets for decades.

约 297 词

Passage 8 Biodiversity Loss and the Urgency of Conservation

环境 · Environment | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Planet Earth is experiencing a biodiversity crisis of alarming magnitude. Conservation biologists estimate that species are vanishing at rates between one hundred and one thousand times higher than the natural background level, a phenomenon widely characterised as the sixth mass extinction in the planet's geological history. Unlike previous extinction events triggered by asteroid impacts or volcanic activity, the current wave is predominantly attributable to human actions.

Habitat destruction remains the principal driver. Forests are cleared to accommodate agricultural expansion, cattle grazing, and urban development; wetlands are drained for commercial exploitation; and coral reefs are bleached by rising ocean temperatures and acidification. Each ecosystem that is degraded or eliminated takes with it species that may never have been scientifically documented, along with biochemical compounds that could potentially yield life-saving pharmaceutical applications.

The introduction of invasive species compounds the problem. When organisms are transported — deliberately or inadvertently — into environments lacking their natural predators, they can proliferate uncontrollably, outcompeting indigenous flora and fauna for resources. Islands are especially susceptible, having evolved ecosystems with limited defensive adaptations against novel threats.

Conservation efforts encompass the establishment of protected reserves, captive breeding programmes for endangered species, and legislative prohibitions on the trade in wildlife products. Yet these measures, however necessary, address symptoms rather than root causes. Sustainable land management, reduced consumption of resource-intensive commodities, and international cooperation to enforce environmental regulations are equally indispensable. The services that intact ecosystems provide — pollination of crops, purification of water, sequestration of atmospheric carbon — are not luxuries but prerequisites for human civilisation's continued prosperity. Ecotourism, when responsibly managed, can generate revenue that incentivises local communities to protect rather than exploit their natural surroundings.

约 277 词

Passage 9 Social Media, Misinformation, and Democratic Discourse

媒体 · Media | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

Social media platforms have fundamentally reconfigured the landscape of public communication. Billions of users worldwide engage daily with networks that facilitate instantaneous sharing of text, images, and video across geographical boundaries that once imposed formidable barriers to interaction. For proponents, these technologies democratise access to information, amplify marginalised voices, and enable civic mobilisation on a scale previously unimaginable.

The velocity with which content circulates online, however, presents corresponding risks. Misinformation — encompassing inaccurate reporting, deliberately fabricated narratives, and content stripped of essential context — can achieve viral dissemination within minutes, reaching audiences that vastly exceed the circulation of traditional print media. Research indicates that emotionally provocative material spreads more rapidly than sober factual analysis, creating incentives for sensationalism that undermine the quality of public deliberation.

Algorithmic curation exacerbates these tendencies. Platforms optimise content recommendations to maximise user engagement, a metric closely correlated with advertising revenue. Consequently, users are frequently presented with material that reinforces pre-existing beliefs rather than challenging them — a dynamic that scholars describe as the 'echo chamber' effect. Political polarisation, erosion of trust in institutional authority, and the normalisation of extremist rhetoric have all been attributed, at least partially, to these algorithmic architectures.

Educational responses emphasise the cultivation of media literacy: the ability to evaluate sources critically, distinguish empirical evidence from opinion, and recognise rhetorical manipulation. Regulatory approaches vary considerably across jurisdictions, ranging from stringent content moderation requirements to principled commitments to freedom of expression. Journalists operating in traditional media outlets have likewise adapted, incorporating fact-checking protocols and transparent correction policies to distinguish their output from the unverified content that proliferates on social networks.

约 267 词

Passage 10 Feeding the World: Agriculture, Sustainability, and Food Security

农业 · Agriculture | IELTS 7.0 (C1)

By the middle of this century, the global population is projected to approach ten billion, intensifying pressure upon agricultural systems already strained by soil degradation, water scarcity, and climatic instability. Conventional farming practices — reliant upon synthetic pesticides, chemical fertilisers, and intensive irrigation — have undeniably increased crop yields over recent decades. Yet these methods frequently inflict collateral damage upon surrounding ecosystems, contaminating waterways, depleting aquifers, and diminishing the biodiversity upon which long-term agricultural resilience depends.

Sustainable agriculture seeks to reconcile the imperative of food production with environmental stewardship. Techniques such as crop rotation, agroforestry, integrated pest management, and precision application of water and nutrients aim to maintain productivity without compromising the capacity of future generations to meet their nutritional requirements. Organic certification schemes, though sometimes criticised for lower yields and elevated consumer prices, have gained substantial market share among environmentally conscious purchasers.

Food security — defined as reliable access to sufficient, safe, and nutritious food — remains unevenly distributed across the globe. While affluent societies discard staggering quantities of edible produce, approximately eight hundred million people continue to experience chronic undernourishment. Conflict, political instability, and infrastructural deficiencies in storage and transportation compound the challenges faced by low-income nations. Climate-related disruptions, including crop failures induced by drought or unseasonable flooding, threaten to exacerbate these inequalities further.

Addressing this multifaceted predicament requires interventions at multiple levels: investment in agricultural research and extension services, reform of trade policies that disadvantage smallholder farmers, reduction of food waste throughout supply chains, and international agreements that prioritise equitable resource allocation. Genetic modification of crops, a subject of intense controversy, proponents argue could enhance resistance to pests and adverse weather, though opponents raise concerns about ecological consequences and corporate control of seed supplies.

约 287 词